

English 633 Marianne Moore and Mina Loy (2015)

Thursday 3:30-6:10 p.m., Clemens 538

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Office, CI 439, office hours: Tuesday 1-2:00; Wednesday 10-11:00

At the end of the 1910s, the two most talked about and arguably the most influential poets in New York were Marianne Moore and Mina Loy. Both published their most innovative work between 1914 and 1925, both affected the development of modernist poetic form, both were reviewed very positively by poets we now think of as canonical (Pound, Eliot, Williams), both published in multiple little magazines, and Moore would go on to become one of the most important editors of the 1920s, editing *The Dial* from 1925-29. This seminar will focus on the poetry written by these two women, primarily in the contexts of the New York scene, gender politics, the role of biography in reception, the visual arts, little magazines, and editorial issues remaining for scholars to address. Class participants will have access to some never-published and hard to access notebooks kept by Moore and used for the writing of her poetry, and an opportunity to engage in some editing.

Required texts:

Moore: Complete Poems (Viking Penguin, 1972). CP

Becoming Marianne Moore: The Early Poems, 1907-1924, ed. Robin G. Schulze (University of California Press, 2002) [this is expensive; if you don't want to buy it you will need to use the library reserve copy or make photocopies; it is in the Poetry Collection: PC]. Hereafter *BMM*. Linda Leavell, Holding on Upside Down: The Life and Work of Marianne Moore (Farrar, Straus, Giroux, 2013).

Do not buy the Grace Schulman edition of Moore's Poems

Loy: *The Lost Lunar Baedeker: Poems of Mina Loy*, ed. Roger Conover (Farrar, Straus and Giroux, 1997). Hereafter *LLB*.

Stories and Essays of Mina Loy, ed. Sara Crangle (Dalkey Archive Press, 2011). *S&E*

The Salt Companion to Mina Loy, ed. Rachel Potter & Suzanne Hobson (Salt, 2010). *SCom*
Caroline Burke, *Becoming Modern: The Life of Mina Loy* (U of California Press, 1996).

Recommended:

Moore, *A-Quiver with Significance: Marianne Moore 1932-1936*, ed. Heather White (ELS Editions, 2008); also White's edition *Adversity & Grace: MM 1936-1941* (ELS, 2012).

Moore, *The Complete Prose*, ed. Patricia C. Willis (Viking, 1986). This volume is now out of print, but you can find cheap used pb copies on line.

Loy, *The Last Lunar Baedeker* (Jargon Society, 1982). This is out of print and hard to find used for under \$100. If you find a cheap copy somewhere you'll probably want to buy it, or at least tell other class members about it.

*Marisa Januzzi unpublished edition of Loy. I will try to get permission to make copies and circulate this DVD to you.

Special Events:

**"21st-Century Moore" University of Houston, March 19-22. Conference website, program

**NYU Workshop on Mina Loy, April 9-10

**February 19 4:30-6:00: lecture by Linda Leavell, "Marianne Moore, Her Mother, Their Biographer"—followed by reception—C1 306

**April 23 3:30-5:00: lecture by Linda Kinnahan, "Portraits of the Poor: Loy's Bowery Poems & the Rise of Documentary Photography"—C1 306

Week 1. Thursday, January 29: Introduction

**Before this class period, read as much as you can of Leavell's *Holding on Upside Down* and Burke's *Becoming Modern*. Discuss Moore's "Poetry" and "Silence"; Loy's "To You" and "Apology of Genius"; discuss role of biography in reception.

Week 2. Thursday, February 5

BMM: Moore's early poems: read *Observations*, with focus on "To be Liked By You Would Be a Calamity," "To Military Progress," "Roses Only," "Sojourn in the Whale," "In the Days of Prismatic Color," "In These Days of Hard Trying, Nonchalance is Good, And," "The Labors of Hercules," and "England" [also read all these poems' "Notes" & "first presentations," in *BMM*].

Criticism: Schulze's "Introduction" & notes on 2 journals of your choice in the "Publication Biography" (PC), and Schulze, "How Not to Edit: The Case of Marianne Moore" & "What a Facsimile Edition Can and Cannot Do: Moore's *Diligence Is to Magic as Progress Is to Flight*" (both in *Textual Cultures*—**online** through JSTOR).

Reviews: *Modernism/Modernity* 21.3 (2014), pp 869-872 and 874-76: reviews of E. Longley, *Yeats and Modern Poetry*; A. Goldstone *Fictions of Autonomy: Modernism from Wilde to de Man*; F. Jameson, *The Antinomies of Realism* (**online** through ProjectMUSE; use name of volume as "title")

Discussion focus: 1910s politics/feminism and little magazines; how to write a good book review

*****Discuss and sign up for book review presentations**

Week 3. Thursday, February 12

BMM: Moore's early long(er) poems: reread *Observations* & read first-presentation & notes for: "Black Earth," "Marriage," "An Octopus," "People's Surroundings";

Criticism: Patricia Willis, "The Road to Paradise: First Notes on Marianne Moore's 'An Octopus'" (*Twentieth Century Literature*—**online** through JSTOR);

Fiona Green, "'The magnitude of their root systems': 'An Octopus'" (UBL);

John Slatin, "The Forms of Resistance" (UBL).

**I will circulate some pages of MM's 1920-21 poetry notebook with transcription. *Discussion focus*: ecological criticism, textual study of intersecting poem sources

FYI: Marianne Moore: *Comprehensive Research and Study Guide*, ed. Harold Bloom, has a long special section on "Marriage" (PC)

Week 4. Thursday, February 19

Class: 3:30-4:30. *The Dial* years. *Selected Letters* 211-227, 234, 246, 248-250 (UBL); *Complete Prose*, "The Dial: A Retrospect," "Comments" (160-169), "Feeling & Precision," & "Humility, Concentration, and Gusto" (UBL)

Criticism: Jayne Marek, "The Ironic 'Editorial We': MM at the *Dial*" (UBL)

Discussion focus: editing/prose as a poetic.

**4:30-6:00 Linda Leavell lecture: "Marianne Moore, Her Mother, Their Biographer"

Week 5. Thursday, February 26

Moore's poems of the 1930s & 1940s: in *Complete Poems*, read "Selected Poems": 5-31, 95-124. Focus on "The Steeple Jack," "The Jerboa," "The Pangolin," "The Paper Nautilus." Also read "In Distrust of Merits" (CP).

Criticism: Odile Harter, "Moore's Depression Collectives," *American Literature* 85.2 (June 2013):331-61;

Miller, "Distrusting: Marianne Moore on Feeling and War in the 1940s," *American Literature* 80.2 (2008): 353-379 (both *Am Lit* essays are available in CI 306, on journal shelves & **UBL**)

Reviews of MM in Gregory's *Critical Response*, 123-126, 133-141 (**UBL**);

Pages from MM's Correspondence & Reading Notebooks (I will make these available).

If you have time, look at *A-Quiver with Significance: Marianne Moore 1932-1936*, ed. Heather White (ELS Editions, 2008) (**PC**).

Discussion focus: MM's evolving style, editing, transcription, the archive

2 book review presentations: _____ & _____

Week 6. Thursday, March 5

MM's late poems, CP 157-250, with focus on "Virginia Britannia," "Nevertheless," "The Mind is an Enchanting Thing," "Voracities and Verities Sometimes are Interacting," "In Lieu of the Lyre," "Arthur Mitchell," "To A Giraffe."

Criticism: John E. Vincent, *Queer Lyrics (Difficulty and Closure in American Poetry)*, 89-121; Bonnie Costello, "Moore's America," in *Shifting Ground* (**UBL**);

Elizabeth Gregory, "'Still Leafing': Celebrity, Confession, Marianne Moore's 'The Camperdown Elm,' and the Scandal of Aging" (*Journal of Modern Literature* **online** through ProjectMUSE).

2 book review presentations: _____ & _____

Week 7. Thursday, March 12: NO CLASS [make-up class TTBD]

Mina Loy poems pp 3-50 and 219-223 in *LLB*.

Criticism: Ezra Pound, T.S. Eliot, William Carlos Williams on MM & ML in Gregory, *The Critical Response* (CrR) 22-32, 77 **UBL** [other reviews are included in the UBL packet but they're not required, or not for this class];

Suzanne Churchill, "ML: The Poetics of Dislodging" (**ER & PC**);

Peter Nicholls "'Arid Clarity': Ezra Pound and ML" (*SCom* 129-145).

Discussion focus: Loy's early poems, and MM/ML's early reception and cultural milieu

1 book review presentation: _____

Thursday, March 19: SPRING BREAK [19-22 Moore Conference in Houston!]

Week 8. Thursday, March 26:

Loy, "Songs to Joannes" and poems of the 1920s (71-105 *LLB*). Also read "Aphorisms on Futurism," "Feminist Manifesto" (*LLB*); "Hush Money," "The Pamperers," "Incident," "Lady Asterisk," & "Gertrude Stein" (*S&E*)

Criticism: Rowan Harris, "Futurism, Fashion, and the Feminine" (in *SCom* 17-46);

Miller, "Sexology, Style, and the Poet's Body," in *Cultures of Modernism* 90-130 [can skip 121-128] (**UBL**);

Rachel Blau DuPlessis, "'seismic orgasm': Sexual Intercourse, Its Modern Representations and Politics" (**UBL**).

[FYI: <http://moore123.com/> has several responses to "Love Songs"/"Songs to Joannes"]

Week 9. Thursday, April 2

“Anglo-Mongrels”—use Januzzi edition DVD. “Three Wishes” (S&E).

Criticism: Lara Vetter, “Theories of Spiritual Evolution, Christian Science, and the ‘cosmopolitan Jew’: Mina Loy and American Identity” (*Journal of Modern Literature* **online** ProjectMUSE);

Rachel Potter, “Obscene Modernism and The Wondering Jew” (in *SCom* 47-70);

Linda Kinnahan, “Economics and Gender in Mina Loy, Lola Ridge, and Marianne Moore” (UBL)

Week 10. Thursday, April 9 NO CLASS [Loy Symposium at NYU]

Week 11. Thursday, April 16

Loy, late poems, *LLB* 109-148. “New York Camelio” & “Monde Triple-Extra” (S&E)

Criticism: Alex Goody, “Carnival Bodies, the Grotesque, and Becoming Animal” (read Loy sections: pp150-157, 173-177 UBL).

Editorial presentations: _____, _____, _____

Week 12. Thursday, April 23

LLB: “Hot Cross Bum,” “On Third Avenue,” “Mass Production,” and “Chiffon Velours”

Criticism: Suzanne Hobson, “Mina Loy’s ‘Conversion’ and the Profane Religion of her Poetry” (*SCom* 248-265)

****3:30-5:00: lecture by Linda Kinnahan, “Portraits of the Poor: Loy’s Bowery Poems & the Rise of Documentary Photography”**

5:10-6:10 **Editorial presentations:** _____, _____

Week 13. Thursday, April 30

Moore and Loy in conversation: MM, “Those Various Scalpels,” “New York,” “The Hero,” “A Face,” “In Lieu of the Lyre” in CP; “‘New’ Poetry Since 1912” (CPr 120-124); “The Ways Our Poets have Taken in Fifteen Years since the War” (CPr 535-539); “Ideas of Order” (CPr 329-331).

ML: “Italian Pictures,” “Three Moments in Paris,” “Time-Bomb,” “An Aged Woman,” and “Modern Poetry” (LLB); “The Metaphysical Pattern in Aesthetics,” “Conversion,” & “Gate Crashers of Olympus” (S&E)

Week 14. Thursday, May 7

*****Seminar presentations**

Requirements:

***write and circulate a response to each week’s reading.** This should be around 2 pages (single spaced) and encapsulate your response to the main idea(s) of at least one piece of the criticism assigned and some aspect of the primary reading; please do not use this response to give an extended reading of a particular poem. Please do point to individual poems or particular arguments that especially interest or puzzle you. These responses must be circulated by 7:00 pm on Tuesday so everyone will have time to read them by Thursday afternoon.

***book review:** you will write a formal book review (maximum 1000 words), as though you were writing to publish the review in a journal. We will discuss in class the requirements for a good review. Your review will be circulated to all members of the class electronically; during the class period, we will have 10 minutes for discussion of your review (you will *not* read the review in class). *Nota bene: Asking good questions is an extremely important part of your professional preparation; those not presenting should come to class prepared to ask questions.*

***transcribe and edit between 1 & 3 pages** of a Moore notebook—choosing from notebooks used for poetry, for reading, or to record conversations. You will distribute your work electronically and present it briefly in class (10 minutes). Goals and structure of this exercise will be discussed in class.

***seminar essay** on Moore, Loy, or Moore & Loy. 15 pages, **due May 12**. Your essay may also in part constitute an editing project, if you are interested in taking on one of the digitized Moore notebooks available for transcription, annotation, and contextual commentary. Should you choose an editorial project and should the work be of a high quality, it will eventually contribute to the Marianne Moore Notebooks Electronic Archive, and you will receive public (“publication”) credit for the work.

Books to choose from for reviewing assignment:

[if there’s something you don’t see here that you’d like to review, check it out with me]

Bazin, Victoria. *Marianne Moore and the Cultures of Modernity* (Ashgate, 2010).

Goody, Alex. *Modernist Articulations: A Cultural Study of Djuna Barnes, Mina Loy and Gertrude Stein* (Palgrave, 2007).

Gregory, Elizabeth. *Quotation and Modern American Poetry: “Imaginary Gardens with Real Toads”* (Texas A&M, 1996).

Leavell, Linda. *Marianne Moore and the Visual Arts*. Louisiana State University Press, 1995.

Parmar, Sandeep. *Reading Mina Loy’s Autobiographies: Myth of the Modern Woman*. Bloomsbury Academic, 2014.

Qian, Zhaoming. *The Modernist Response to Chinese Art: Pound, Moore, Stevens* (Penn State UP, 2008).

Schulze, Robin. *The Degenerate Muse: American Nature, Modernist Poetry, and the Problem of Cultural Hygiene* (Oxford, 2013).

Swigg, Richard. *“Quick, Said the Bird”: Williams, Eliot, Moore and the Spoken Word* (U of Iowa P, 2012).

Vetter, Lara. *Modernist Writings and Religion-Scientific Discourse: H.D., Loy, and Toomer* (Palgrave, 2010).

Vincent, John Emil. *Queer Lyrics: Difficulty and Closure in Modern American Poetry* (Palgrave, 2002).

Material Available Online:

[I would now add: The Marianne Moore Digital Archive, <https://moorearchive.org/> ; Mina Loy on-line <https://oncomouse.github.io/loy/> and <http://mina-loy.com/> .]

The Modernist Journals Project: <http://modjourn.org/journals.html>. Includes issues of *Camera Work*, *The Egoist*, *The Little Review*, *Others*, *Poetry*, and several other little magazines in which MM & ML published.

Index to Little Magazines: <http://sites.davidson.edu/littlemagazines/magazines/>

Moore Bibliography 2000-present:

http://www.uh.edu/class/ws/Programs/ConferencesColloquia/Marianne_Moore/ An online bibliography (in progress) of Moore criticism published in the 21st century. [There is excellent work on Moore written in the 1980s and 1990s, so please do not regard this list as complete!]

Moore blog and bibliography: <http://moore123.com/>

Limited access to Loy's visual art:

<http://www.francisnaumann.com/Daughters%20of%20DADA/Loy.html> [Francis Naumann Gallery, NY] & http://www.english.illinois.edu/maps/poets/g_l/loy/artworks.htm [from Carolyn Burke's biography]

The fullest reproduction of her art remains that in the 1982 *Last Lunar Baedeker*.

Required Reading Critical Essays bibliography:

Suzanne Churchill, "ML: The Poetics of Dislodging." In *The Little Magazine Others and the Renovation of Modern American Poetry*. Ashgate, 2006. [also has excellent chapter on Moore]

Costello, Bonnie. "Moore's America," in *Shifting Ground: Reinventing Landscape in Modern American Poetry*. Harvard University Press, 2003.

DuPlessis, Rachel Blau. "'seismic orgasm': Sexual Intercourse, Its Modern Representations and Politics." In *Genders, Races and Religious Cultures in Modern American Poetry: 1908-1934*. Cambridge UP, 2001.

Goody, Alex. "Carnival Bodies, the Grotesque, and Becoming Animal." In *Modernist Articulations: A Cultural Study of Djuna Barnes, Mina Loy and Gertrude Stein*. Palgrave, 2007.

Green, Fiona. "'The magnitude of their root systems': 'An Octopus'." In *Poets and Critics Read Marianne Moore*, ed. Linda Leavell, Cristanne Miller, Robin Schulze. Bucknell University Press, 2005.

Gregory, Elizabeth. "'Still Leafing': Celebrity, Confession, Marianne Moore's 'The Camperdown Elm,' and the Scandal of Aging." *Journal of Modern Literature* 35.3 (2012): 51-76.

_____, ed. *The Critical Response to Marianne Moore*. Praeger, 2003.

Harris, Rowan. "Futurism, Fashion, and the Feminine." In *Salt Companion* 17-46.

Harter, Odile. "Moore's Depression Collectives," *American Literature* 85.2 (June 2013):331-61

Hobson, Suzanne. "Mina Loy's 'Conversion' and the Profane Religion of her Poetry." In *Salt Companion* 248-265.

Kinnahan, Linda. "Economics and Gender in Mina Loy, Lola Ridge, and Marianne Moore." In *Oxford Companion to Twentieth-Century American Poetry*, ed. Cary Nelson. Oxford University Press, 2011.

Leavell, Linda, Cristanne Miller, and Robin Schulze. Critics and Poets on Marianne Moore: A Right Good Salvo of Barks. Bucknell UP, 2005.

Miller, Cristanne. "Distrusting: Marianne Moore on Feeling and War in the 1940s," *American Literature* 80.2 (2008): 353-379.

_____. "Sexology, Style, and the Poet's Body," in *Cultures of Modernism: Marianne Moore, Mina Loy, and Else Lasker-Schüler*. University of Michigan Press, 2005.

Moore, Marianne. *Complete Prose*. Ed. Patricia C. Willis. Viking, 1986.

_____. *Selected Letters*. Ed. Bonnie Costello, Celeste Goodridge, Cristanne Miller. Knopf, 1997.

Peter Nicholls "'Arid Clarity': Ezra Pound and ML." *Salt Companion* 129-145.

Potter, Rachel. "Obscene Modernism and The Wondering Jew." In *Salt Companion* 47-70.

Schulze, Robin G. "How Not to Edit: The Case of Marianne Moore." *Textual Cultures* 2.1 (2007):119-135.

_____. "What a Facsimile Edition Can and Cannot Do: Moore's *Diligence Is to Magic as Progress Is to Flight*." *Textual Cultures*

Slatin, John. "The Forms of Resistance." In *The Savage's Romance: The Poetry of Marianne Moore*. Pennsylvania State University Press, 1986.

Lara Vetter, "Theories of Spiritual Evolution, Christian Science, and the 'cosmopolitan Jew': Mina Loy and American Identity" *Journal of Modern Literature* 31.1 (2007): 47-63.

Vincent, John E. "The Magician's Advance: Late Moore." In *Queer Lyrics: Difficulty and Closure in American Poetry*. Palgrave Macmillan, 2002.

Patricia Willis, "The Road to Paradise: First Notes on Marianne Moore's 'An Octopus'," *Twentieth Century Literature* 30.2-3 (1984): 242-266.

OTHER READING that may interest you and is unlikely to be on the MM bibliographies:

Altieri, Charles. "The Doctrine of Impersonality and Modernism's War on Rhetoric: Eliot, Loy, and Moore." In *The Art of Twentieth-Century American Poetry: Modernism and After*. Blackwell, 2006. [chapter on Eliot, Moore, Loy]

Armstrong, Tim. *Modernism, Technology, and the Body: A Cultural Study*. Cambridge University Press, 1998. [Chapter on Loy]

_____. "Loy and Cornell: Christian Science and the Destruction of the World." Available online: <http://personal.rhul.ac.uk/UHLE/012/Loy%20and%20Cornell.pdf>

Bochner, Jay. *An American Lens: Scenes from Alfred Stieglitz's New York Secession*. MIT Press, 2005. [Chapter on Loy and Williams]

Dalziel, Tanyz. "The Sound of an Idea: Music in the Modernist Writings of Gertrude Stein and Mina Loy." *Music and Literary Modernism*, ed. Robert McParland. Cambridge Scholars Publishing, 110-125.

Hart, Matthew. *Nations of Nothing but Poetry*. Oxford University Press, 2010. [chapter on MM]

Paul, Catherine. *Poetry in the Museums of Modernism*. University of Michigan, 2002. [chapter on MM]

Potter, Rachel. *Modernism and Democracy: Literary Culture 1900-1930*. Oxford University Press, 2006. [Chapter on Loy]

Pozorski, Aimee L. "Eugenicist Mistress & Ethnic Mother: Mina Loy and Futurism, 1913-1917," *MELUS*, 30.3 (2005): 41-69. (JSTOR)

Sawelson-Gorse, Naomi, ed. *Women and Dada*. MIT Press, 1998. [chapter on Loy]

Whalen, Mark. "Mourning and Jazz in the Poetry of Mina Loy." In *Modernism and Mourning*, ed. Patricia Rae. Associated University Presses, 2007.

Willis, Patricia C., ed. *Marianne Moore: Vision into Verse*. Rosenbach Museum & Library, 1987.

Zelazo, Suzanne. “’Altered Observation of Modern Eyes’: Mina Loy’s Collages, and Multisensual Aesthetics” (available online: <http://www.ingentaconnect.com/content/berg/tsas/2009/00000004/00000001/art00003>).